



THE COCKPIT

Spartan by today's standards, all varnished wood and copper tubes and brass fittings, and with instruments and items of equipment seemingly positioned wherever they would fit, the S.E.5a's "office" was typical of the period in its functional approach, with little concession to pilot comfort or ease of use. Both of the aircraft's two machine guns—the fixed internal Vickers and the movable overwing-rail-mounted Lewis—could be accessed by the pilot in flight to clear jams and, in the case of the Lewis, change the drum-shaped ammunition magazine.

15. Cockpit general view 16. Fuel pump control 17. Fuel cock
18. Compass 19. Airspeed indicator 20. Control column spade grip with gun-firing buttons 21. Rudder bar 22. Radiator shutter lever